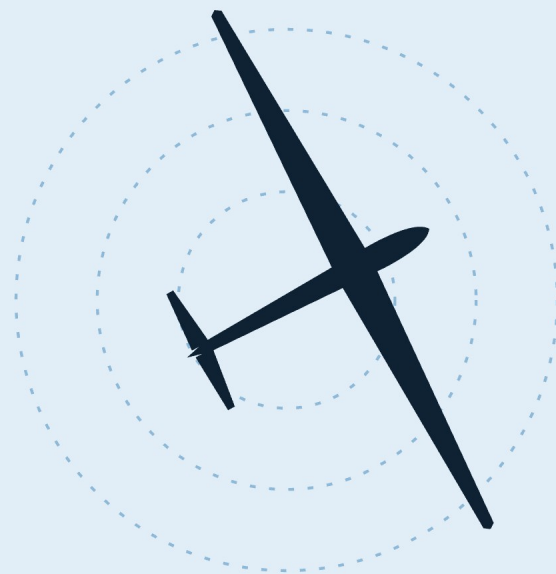


# COME FLY WITH US.

No engine. No experience needed. A winch launch to about 2,000 feet, and some of the quietest flying in Saskatchewan.



## START IN THREE STEPS

# 1

### Book a first flight

Type your name on the [Flying Schedule](#) under the day you want. A Discovery Flight is \$50. No membership and no experience needed.



Flying Schedule

# 2

### Liked it? Join the club

Fill in the short [membership form](#) and e-transfer your dues to [pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com](mailto:pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com).



Membership form

# 3

### Come back and learn to fly

Put your name on the same schedule whenever you want a lesson. Instruction is free. You pay only for launches and glider time.

## \$50

first flight, no membership needed

## Free

instruction from club instructors

## 25 min

from Prince Albert, 1.5 hours from Saskatoon

# The Flying Schedule, made easy

Booking means typing your name into one cell of a shared Google Sheet. It takes about a minute.

|                                                       | Fri Oct 2                      | Sat Oct 3 · your day                            | Sun Oct 4                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Weather forecast</b>                               | forecast                       | clouds, temperature, wind                       | forecast                       |
| <b>Status / Comments</b>                              |                                | flying on, delayed or off, and the arrival time |                                |
| <b>Introductory Familiarization Flights</b>           | Intro Fam Flight Sign-up Below | <b>Intro Fam Flight Sign-up Below</b>           | Intro Fam Flight Sign-up Below |
|                                                       |                                | <b>Your name + phone</b>                        |                                |
| <b>Students / Pilots</b><br>please sign up in advance | Student/Pilots Sign-up Below   | <b>Student/Pilots Sign-up Below</b>             | Student/Pilots Sign-up Below   |
|                                                       |                                | another member                                  | another member                 |
|                                                       |                                | <b>Your name</b>                                |                                |
| <b>Instructors</b><br>a name here = lessons are on    | Instructors Sign-up Below      | Instructors Sign-up Below                       | Instructors Sign-up Below      |
|                                                       |                                | an instructor                                   | an instructor                  |

□ Where you type. You only ever use one column (your day) and one block (your sign-up section). Ignore the rest.

## 1 Open the schedule

On a computer, open the link in your browser. Sign in with any Google account.

## 2 Find your day

Dates run across the top row. Scroll sideways until yours is on screen. Weekends are the main flying days.

## 3 Find your block

First flight: the cell reading "Intro Fam Flight Sign-up Below". Lesson: "Student/Pilots Sign-up Below".

## 4 Type your name

Use the first empty cell underneath and press Enter. For a first flight, add your phone number. It saves by itself.

### On a phone?

In a phone browser the sheet is usually view-only. Install the free Google Sheets app and open the link there.

# The morning you fly: three checks

## Status / Comments row

Is flying on, delayed or cancelled? The day's arrival time is posted here too.

## Weather row

A quick look at wind and conditions. The forecast fills in about a week ahead.

## Instructors block

For lessons: an instructor's name under your date means instruction is on.

**Always check the sheet before you leave home. Gliding depends on the weather, and last-minute changes are posted there.**

## Stuck? We'll do it for you

If the sheet won't let you type, message the WhatsApp group, email [pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com](mailto:pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com) or ask any instructor. We'll put your name down.

## Sign up early, even as a maybe

Write "(maybe)" after your name. It helps instructors plan the day. If your plans change, delete your name.

# Your first day

Arrive at the time posted for your date in the Status / Comments row. Arrival times change with the season and conditions, so have a quick look that morning.

## BRING

- Hat, sunscreen, sunglasses
- Water, lunch or snacks
- Layers: it's cooler at altitude
- A way to pay by e-transfer
- A phone or camera, if you like

## HOW THE DAY RUNS

1. Meet the crew and get a safety briefing.
2. Help get the glider out. Pitching in is part of the fun, and it keeps costs low.
3. Fly: a winch launch to about 2,000 feet, with a club pilot beside you the whole time.
4. Stay, watch, learn, and fly again if time allows.

Guest flying is usually on weekends and holidays, about 1 to 5 pm, weather permitting. The main season runs spring through fall, with occasional winter flying.

# What it costs

# \$10

is about what a typical 10-minute lesson flight costs: a \$5 launch plus \$5 of glider time. Instruction is free.

| WHAT                          | PRICE (CAD)  | GOOD TO KNOW                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Discovery Flight (guest)      | \$50         | \$40 each for a group of 4 or more. About 8 to 30 minutes in the air. No membership needed. |
| Membership, Regular           | \$150 / year | For anyone not covered by the two categories below.                                         |
| Membership, Junior            | \$75 / year  | Under 21, or a full-time student under 25.                                                  |
| Membership, Youth / Air Cadet | \$15 / year  | Under 19.                                                                                   |
| Winch launch (members)        | \$5 each     | To about 2,000 feet.                                                                        |
| Glider rental (members)       | \$30 / hour  | Billed by the minute, at \$0.50.                                                            |
| Instruction                   | Free         | Taught by club members who hold an instructor rating.                                       |

Every membership includes Soaring Association of Canada membership. New members joining after August 1 pay half. Ages are as of January 1 of the membership year. Pay by e-transfer to [pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com](mailto:pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com).

## Quick answers

### Do I have to join before my first flight?

No. Try a \$50 Discovery Flight first and join only if you love it.

### Is it safe to just try once?

An experienced club pilot or instructor is in command. Gliding carries risk similar to other small-aircraft flying, and safety is the club's first priority.

### Do I need my own glider or gear?

No. The club provides the glider, the winch and free instruction.

### What if the weather cancels my day?

It happens. Pick another date on the schedule and sign up again. There is no charge for a flight that didn't happen.

## WHY GLIDING?

# A sport you never finish

Gliding is to powered flying what sailing is to motorboating. With an engine, the flying serves the trip. In a glider, the flying is the game.

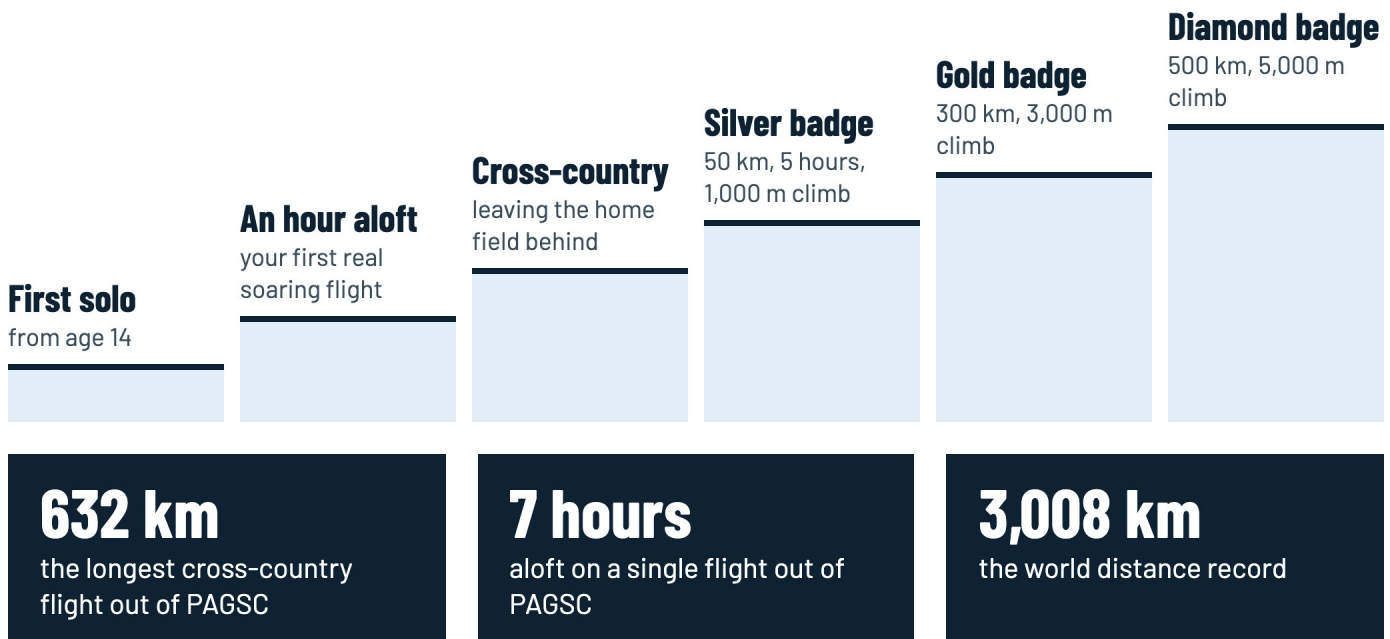
## THE GAME

There is no throttle, so every flight is a puzzle: find rising air, climb in it, decide where to go next. The sky changes by the hour. Some days it gives you 10 minutes, some days 10 hours.

## AND THEN THERE'S RACING

Cross-country gliding is also a race: fly a set course around turnpoints, and the fastest average speed wins. Any flight can be scored online and ranked against pilots around the world.

## Always a next rung



## A SPORT FOR DECADES

Gliding rewards judgment more than strength, so a 16-year-old and a 70-year-old fly the same sky. And nobody launches alone: it takes a crew, which is why it works as a club.

## IT MAKES BETTER PILOTS

Gliding builds stick-and-rudder skill and energy management like nothing else. The captains of both the "Miracle on the Hudson" and the "Gimli Glider" were glider pilots.

# Learning to fly

## Any age

start training, no experience needed

## Age 14

fly solo

## Age 16

hold a full Glider Pilot Licence

### WHO CAN LEARN

- All flying before solo is dual, with a certified instructor as pilot-in-command.
- You need to reach the controls comfortably (roughly 5 ft tall) and be ready to learn (typically 12 and up).
- Maximum weight for an introductory flight is 230 lbs.
- Our two-seat trainer is a Schleicher K7.

### COME REGULARLY IF YOU CAN

Skills fade between visits. Flying most weekends over a stretch of the season gets you solo sooner and costs less in total.

## Your path to a Glider Pilot Licence

### 1 Flight lessons

Dual lessons in the air with an instructor, at your own pace. Book each one on the schedule.

### 2 Medical: do this early

Most students use a Category 4 medical, a self-declaration with no doctor's visit. Do it and your student licence paperwork early. A Category 1 or 3 also counts.

### 3 Ground school and the GLIDE exam

15 hours, self-directed or with [pilottraining.ca](http://pilottraining.ca), then Transport Canada's GLIDE written exam (60% to pass).

### 4 First solo, from age 14

Once your instructor is satisfied you are ready.

### 5 Licence, from age 16

Solo practice, then a flight test. You need at least 6 hours of flight time, including 1 hour dual and 2 hours solo.

# Youth and cadets: learn for less

## \$1,000

toward launches and glider rental: a \$500 Soaring Association of Canada bursary, matched by \$500 from the club

With the \$15 youth membership, a glider licence can cost very little. Ask us and we'll help you apply.

Air Cadets who earn their Glider Pilot Licence here can also do a Soaring Pilot Conversion for their cadet wings.

## Already a power pilot?

With a PPL(A) you skip ground school and the written exam, and need 3 flight hours, not 6.

| REQUIREMENT              | FROM SCRATCH                   | WITH PPL(A) CREDIT             |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Medical</b>           | Category 1, 3 or 4             | Your existing Category 1 or 3  |
| <b>Ground school</b>     | 15 hours                       | <b>Waived</b>                  |
| <b>Written exam</b>      | GLIDE, 60% to pass             | <b>Waived</b>                  |
| <b>Total flight time</b> | 6 hours                        | <b>3 hours</b>                 |
| <b>Dual instruction</b>  | 1 hour                         | 1 hour                         |
| <b>Solo flight time</b>  | 2 hours                        | 2 hours                        |
| <b>Skill assessment</b>  | Flight demo and recommendation | Flight demo and recommendation |

**It works the other way too.** Up to 5 hours of glider time counts toward a PPL(A), and up to 50 hours toward the 200-hour total for a CPL(A).

### LEARN AT HOME, FREE

#### SOAR manual

[Free PDF](#) from the Soaring Association of Canada, at [sac.ca](http://sac.ca)

#### Safe winch launching videos

British Gliding Association:  
[members.gliding.co.uk/safety/safe-winchng](http://members.gliding.co.uk/safety/safe-winchng)

#### Glider Flying Handbook

Free from the FAA at [faa.gov](http://faa.gov)

# The fleet

Three gliders: a two-seat trainer and two single-seaters.



## Schleicher K7 Rhönadler **TWO-SEAT TRAINER**

Where every first flight and lesson happens. Steel-tube fuselage with wood and fabric wings, designed by Rudolf Kaiser as a trainer.

| SEATS    | WINGSPAN      | BEST GLIDE  | MIN. SINK       | EMPTY WEIGHT  | INTRODUCED  |
|----------|---------------|-------------|-----------------|---------------|-------------|
| <b>2</b> | <b>16.0 m</b> | <b>26:1</b> | <b>0.70 m/s</b> | <b>282 kg</b> | <b>1960</b> |



## Schleicher Ka 6E **SINGLE-SEATER**

One of the most loved and best-handling gliders ever made. A classic wooden sailplane, also a Rudolf Kaiser design, with an all-flying tailplane.

| SEATS    | WINGSPAN      | BEST GLIDE  | MIN. SINK       | EMPTY WEIGHT  | INTRODUCED  |
|----------|---------------|-------------|-----------------|---------------|-------------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>15.0 m</b> | <b>32:1</b> | <b>0.65 m/s</b> | <b>190 kg</b> | <b>1965</b> |



## Bölkow Phoebus C **SINGLE-SEATER**

An early fibreglass sailplane with a 17-metre wing, a T-tail and a retractable wheel. The highest performer of the three.

| SEATS    | WINGSPAN      | BEST GLIDE  | MIN. SINK       | EMPTY WEIGHT  | INTRODUCED  |
|----------|---------------|-------------|-----------------|---------------|-------------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>17.0 m</b> | <b>39:1</b> | <b>0.63 m/s</b> | <b>240 kg</b> | <b>1967</b> |

**Reading the numbers.** A best glide of 26:1 means 26 metres forward for every metre of height lost: about 16 km from a 2,000 ft launch in still air. Minimum sink is how slowly the glider descends when flown for time aloft.

# SEE YOU AT THE FIELD.

Book a Discovery Flight, or come out to Birch Hills on a flying weekend and say hello.



## Book a flight or lesson

[Flying Schedule](#), also under "Book a Flight" at [pagsc.ca](http://pagsc.ca)



## Join the club

[Membership form](#)  
[forms.gle/ZrPrU5r4kEfuRdu39](https://forms.gle/ZrPrU5r4kEfuRdu39)



## Join the conversation

[Club WhatsApp group](#), for carpooling and quick questions

## QUESTIONS

**Email** [pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com](mailto:pa.gliding.soaring.club@gmail.com)

**Phone** (306) 222-5684

**Website** [pagsc.ca](http://pagsc.ca)

**Facebook** [PAGSC.Saskatchewan](https://www.facebook.com/PAGSC.Saskatchewan)

## GETTING THERE

Birch Hills Airport is on Highway 3, about 25 minutes from Prince Albert and 1.5 hours from Saskatoon. Directions from both are linked in the schedule's left-hand column.

Carpooling is often available from Saskatoon, Martensville and Warman. Ask in the WhatsApp group.

PAGSC is a non-profit club affiliated with the Soaring Association of Saskatchewan and the Soaring Association of Canada. This is a friendly guide. The schedule sheet, [pagsc.ca](http://pagsc.ca) and our instructors are the final word on dates, weather and fees. Prices current at October 2026.